

The Berean Check

Eight tests for any teaching, any AI answer, any clip that moves you. Tick what passes. Anything that fails one test is set aside until a person you trust has looked at it.



Beloved, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits to see whether they are from God, for many false prophets have gone out into the world.

1 JOHN 4:1, ESV



The Scripture test

Does it agree with the whole Bible, read in context, not with one verse pulled out of it?

ISAIAH 8:20 • ACTS 17:11



The Christ test

Does it confess Jesus Christ, come in the flesh, crucified, risen, and Lord? Anything vague about Jesus is not from the Spirit.

1 JOHN 4:2-3



The gospel test

Is salvation by grace through faith, or does this add a step, a payment, a secret, or a performance?

GALATIANS 1:8 • EPHESIANS 2:8-9



The fruit test

What does it grow in you? Love, joy, peace, patience, or fear, pride, secrecy, and contempt for the church?

MATTHEW 7:16 • GALATIANS 5:22-23



The source test

Can you find the verse, the quote, or the study yourself, in a real Bible or the original recording, in under a minute? If not, treat it as unsaid.

PROVERBS 18:17



The flattery test

Does it only tell you what you already wanted to hear? Faithful wounds come from friends. Endless agreement comes from something else.

PROVERBS 27:6 • 2 TIMOTHY 4:3



The isolation test

Does it pull you toward your church and the people who know you, or quietly away from them?

HEBREWS 10:25



The counsel test

Have two mature believers heard this and agreed? Not liked the clip. Heard the claim, and agreed.

PROVERBS 11:14 • MATTHEW 18:16

The verse-check drill. Sixty seconds.

1

Open the reference in two translations

If the words differ in any way that changes the meaning, stop.

2

Read the paragraph, not the verse

Five verses before, five after. Most misuse is a true verse in a false frame.

3

Say who said it and to whom

Context is the difference between a verse and a slogan.

Four things AI must never become

- **Never** your pastor. It cannot shepherd you, and it will not show up at the hospital.
- **Never** your confessor. A chatbot is not "one another."
- **Never** your closest friend. A model has no edge. Iron sharpens iron.
- **Never** your Bible. A summary of Scripture is not Scripture.

The household rule that works: AI helps with tasks. People handle hearts. If the conversation has moved from a task to a heart, it has moved past what the tool is for. Take it to a person that day.

A rule of life for AI

Ten commitments. Put this where the screen is. Read it aloud with your household and your team once, and then live it.



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|-------------|---|
| I | The Word before the screen. Scripture is opened first every day, with my own eyes, before any tool is. |
| II | The Spirit has the final word. When a model and the Spirit disagree, the model is wrong. |
| III | Nothing speaks to God for me. My prayers, my confession, and my worship are my own. |
| IV | Nothing speaks as God to me. Any tool that answers as Jesus or prophecies over me is closed and deleted. |
| V | Verify before I repeat. No verse, quote, or claim leaves my mouth as fact until I have seen the source. |
| VI | People over prompts. No chatbot is my pastor, confessor, closest friend, or Bible. Hearts go to a person. |
| VII | My sources are chosen, named, and tested. The machine answers from a shelf I built on purpose. |
| VIII | I own what I build, and I say when AI helped. Stewardship, not extraction. It runs without me and hands off with the keys. |
| IX | I count the cost first. Before anyone depends on it, I know what it costs, who owns it, and what it will never do. |
| X | I keep one thing by hand. Every week, one prayer, letter, or page of Scripture written with no machine in the room. |

Put your pastor in front of Google

- 1 Sign in, open google.com/preferences/source**
Signed in makes it follow you to every device.
- 2 Search your church's domain, then your pastor's**
A domain or subdomain qualifies. A page path does not.
- 3 Tick the box**
It appears under "Your sources" and is badged Preferred in Top Stories, AI Overviews and AI Mode.
- 4 Ask your church to add the button**
google.com/preferences/source?q=yourchurch.org works with no code.

For the household

- Devices live in shared rooms. AI conversations are never private from a parent or a spouse.
- No companion apps. A child's friend has a face and a family.
- Homework uses the Socratic rule: the tool asks, the child answers.
- Any prayer, verse, or "word from God" from an app is brought to the table and tested together.
- The Sabbath is unplugged. One day in seven the tools rest.

For the church: a written policy naming what AI may touch (research yes, preaching no, pastoral care no, admin yes). Every public AI use disclosed in one line. No member data into a tool the church does not control. Two elders review any AI-built system before members depend on it.